

the power of minus 14 Watts of power at handset and it still works.. How and why need to be thought about!," says Ashok Jhunjhunwala, IIT-M.

Service Provider

Examples: Airtel
Vodafone
Aircel
BSNL
Reliance

Manufacturing of equipment

Examples: Alcatel Lucent
Nortel
Ericsson

Types of employers

☐ Service provider

People who understand the box applications of infrastructure are needed in this department. These people go out and create the infrastructure.

- Sales guys for equipment – you need engineers who can sell
- Administration people – who are familiar with the industry and look at expanding
- People for the maintenance of infrastructure

☐ Manufacturing of equipment

- System design of low level firmware/chipware
- Mechanical aspect for the box. People should be able to service and test.
- People to actually manufacture the equipment

☐ Consumer-end

- People who understand circuit boards and embedded software
- People who know operating systems and software

☐ Services for the end-user (VAS)

- People who can develop software applications

What makes people successful in this career?

According to Indu Kapoor, HR business partner, Research and Development, Alcatel Lucent, NCR Region, the people she has noticed to succeed in this field are those with the ability to analyse a problem and develop solutions quickly. These people have the constant need to learn. Once they have learned something new they should be able to figure out how to apply it. "Can they make their product faster, lighter, last longer? They should have the desire to improvise," she says.

For a leadership role, she points out that it is not critical for the candidate to have an in-depth knowledge in the domain. The leader does not have to get into code-level instructions, instead she says that they may have other abilities, like the ability to motivate people.

What are the alternate mid-career changes possible?

According to Indu Kapoor of Alcatel Lucent, telecom is not a sector that people leave very easily. Her reasons are that the nature of the job is just that exciting, and on top of this the pay is usually higher than other sectors.